NDA. He is today an aspiring army officer, for he worked extremely hard and made it to the Army Cadet College, Dehradun. He plays volleyball for the college and is doing well in academics. He was perhaps the first student from the Army Public School to have joined the army as a soldier. God willing, he shall be commissioned from the Indian Military Academy as an officer in December 2013. It would be a proud day for Rohini and me. Soon after I became the chief, a media report about Kuljit went like this, 'Seven years ago a young, trembling boy travelled all the way from Doda in Jammu and Kashmir to Delhi where he was being given a new home. Kuljit, the seven year old who used to sleep under the bed for fear of militants today hopes to become an officer in the Indian Army. He's just written out his story and a line of it says, "I met someone like God seven years ago…." The "God", he was referring to, is General Joginder Jaswant Singh, the new Chief of Army Staff.'[2]

The second child is James, who was in a children's home in Kohima, the capital of strife-torn Nagaland. We took on the responsibility of his upbringing in 2006, when he was about ten years old. He was also educated in the Army Public School, Delhi, during my tenure as army chief. Thereafter, I got him admitted to the Sainik School, near Kohima, Nagaland. He has recently completed his tenth board examination and is doing very well. He is a prefect in the school and the captain of the football team. He will shortly be taking the NDA exam to be an army officer. A Christmas and New Year card that gives us unending joy every year is a handpainted one that has the signatures of over a hundred boys and girls from Father D'Souza's home at Kohima, the children's home from where James came (see Appendix 8).

Two decades ago, when I was a brigadier, I had taken my ailing mother to the hospital. There I met an officer whose wife had been diagnosed with a malignancy. I met the lady and told her to imagine that she was confronted by a tiger in a jungle. She could either close her eyes and let the tiger finish her or she could pick up a stick and fight it. She might survive or die fighting the beast, I told her. We never met again. When I became the chief, I was quite amazed to receive a letter of congratulations from the same officer, who went